

README

HXC-168 — credential scrub: captured evidence

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What this run proves

The §11.4.115 polarity pair for the HXC-168 exposure class, captured from the SAME test source in both directions, plus the §1.1 mutation that shows the guard can still fail.

- **RED on the pre-fix artifact** — the defect genuinely reproduces on the broken tree, not on a synthetic fixture. Run from a - - shared clone checked out at 2182d644~1 (1f67b44f), i.e. before the scrub landed: **41 findings, RED PASS**. A RED test that cannot fail on the known-broken artifact is a blind test, so this is the leg that earns the GREEN.
- **GREEN on the fixed artifact** — same source, RED_MODE=0: **GREEN PASS with 1 OPERATOR-BLOCKED**. Not “all clear”: the running container still publishes *:55432 because its SOURCE already binds loopback and podman cannot rebind a published port in place, so it closes only on an operator-gated recreate.
- **§1.1 mutation** — revert the source publish to the wildcard and the same runtime turns from OPERATOR-BLOCKED into **2 findings, GREEN FAIL exit 1**. That is what proves OPERATOR-BLOCKED is a discriminator and not a carve-out.

- **Gate self-test** — 8 paired mutations, exit 0. Planted literals are REDACTED here (<REDACTED-L1> / <REDACTED-L2>): the self-test deliberately plants them to prove detection, and a transcript is not a place to publish a credential (§11.4.10). The verdicts are untouched.
- **Sweep** — G35 and G36 each Gates run: 1, both PASS.

Files

File	What it is
01_RED_on_prefix_artifact.log	Defect reproduced on the pre-scrub tree (41 findings)
02_GREEN_on_fixed_artifact.log	Same test, fixed tree, 1 operator-blocked
03_MUTATION_wildcard_source.log	Paired mutation: wildcard source ⇒ 2 findings
04_gate_selftest.log	Gate's own 8 paired mutations (literals redacted)
05_sweep_G35_G36.log	Both registered gates via the sweep

What it does NOT prove

Stated plainly, because a green transcript invites the opposite reading:

- **The credential is still valid.** Nothing here rotates it. It is in git history on four mirrors and remains usable until it is rotated at the database — an operator action no gate can perform.
- **:55432 is still LAN-reachable.** The loopback bind is landed in source only. The recreate that would apply it needs an app-layer cycle, because the credential is injected by internal/infraboot during the application's boot rather than by a standalone launcher.
- **This is not a closure.** HXC-168 remains Operator-blocked. Per §11.4.83 the transcripts are captured NOW so the RED leg is not reconstructed from memory later; the item closes when the operator's two actions are done.